

I SHOCK AND GLORY

On the day of reckoning, the buzz was also about the fortunes of high-profile candidates

LOSERS



VAIKO
(MDMK)
from Virudhunagar



RAM VILAS PASWAN
(LJP)
from Hajipur



VINOD KHANNA
(BJP)
from Gurdaspur



A.R. ANTULAY
(INC)
from Raigad



CHETAN CHAUHAN
(BJP)
from East Delhi



MANI SHANKAR AIYAR
(INC)
from Mayiladuthurai



RENUKA CHOWDHURY
(INC)
from Khammam



GEORGE FERNANDES
(INDEPENDENT)
from Muzaffarpur



MANVENDRA SINGH
(BJP)
from Barmer



SADHU YADAV
(INC) from Paschim
Champaran

WINNERS



VARUN GANDHI
(BJP)
from Pilibhit



JAYAPRADA
(SP)
from Rampur



JASWANT SINGH
(BJP)
from Darjeeling



SUPRIYA SULE
(NCP)
from Baramati



MURLI MANOHAR JOSHI (BJP) from
Varanasi



P. CHIDAMBARAM
(INC)
from Sivaganga



SHASHI THAROOR
(INC) from Thiruvananthapuram



SHATRUGHAN SINHA
(BJP)
from Patna Sahib



M.K. AZHAGIRI
(DMK)
from Madurai



SHIBU SOREN
(JMM)
from Dumka

MULAYAM SINGH YADAV

In the Margins

For others, befriending former BJP leader Kalyan Singh could have created problems, but he's saved Samajwadi Party (SP) president Mulayam Singh Yadav from decimation in the Lok Sabha elections. Yadav may have come down from his 35-seat tally of 2004, but it has been the OBCs and a section of the non-Jatav Scheduled Castes who have helped him win, whatever little he could manage. Not a single Brahmin or Muslim has won seats for Mulayam's party.

The Muslim exodus from the SP camp would have threatened Yadav's survival, especially after the rout he faced in the 2007 assembly elections. In teaming up with Singh, Yadav has succeeded in his gameplan of a grand mobilisation of the OBCs. After delimitation, the SP chief had sensed that geographical and demographic changes in many constituencies did not favour his party. So he baited a sulking Kalyan Singh and joined hands with him to consolidate his position with the support of the Lodhs, another OBC section. This support was behind the victory of SP candidates, including Mulayam's son Akhilesh

A SHAKEN MULAYAM WILL HAVE TO CONSOLIDATE HIS SUPPORT ALL OVER AGAIN



THE RESULTS CLEARLY SHOW THAT MULAYAM IS NEITHER KING NOR KINGMAKER BUT IS AT BEST A REGIONAL LEADER WHOSE NATIONAL AMBITIONS HAVE BEEN PUT ON HOLD.